Poultry Drinker



Category: **Animal Husbandry & Dairy** Type: **Short SOP** Priority: **Medium** 4 labs

Covers these lab items: Linear Waterer/Channel Type Waterer; Manual Drinker; Nipple Drinker; Pan and Jar Type Waterer

What it is used for

To supply clean drinking water to poultry using a suitable drinker system. To maintain reliable water access and reduce spillage and contamination.

Main parts

- Water container or supply line
- Drinker channel, nipple, pan, or jar
- Valve or float mechanism, if fitted
- Mounting supports
- Water filter, if fitted

Before you start

1. Select a drinker suitable for the birds' age and housing system.
2. Wash and disinfect drinker components according to farm procedures.
3. Check the water supply, valves, and fittings for leaks or blockage.
4. Position the drinker at an appropriate height for the birds.
5. Ensure the water source is clean and accessible.

How to use

1. Fill the container or connect the supply line securely.
2. Open the supply valve gradually if applicable.
3. Check that water reaches all drinker points.
4. Adjust height and flow according to the birds' needs and system instructions.
5. Observe birds using the drinker and confirm water is available.
6. Remove spilled feed or litter from the water area.
7. Clean and refill the drinker on the farm's schedule.

⚠ Safety

- Use clean water suitable for poultry.
- Avoid sharp edges and unstable mounting.
- Prevent electrical equipment from contacting spilled water.
- Follow farm biosecurity and sanitation procedures.

Care & storage

- Wash and disinfect the drinker regularly.
- Check nipples, valves, and seals for leaks or blockages.
- Remove algae and mineral deposits as appropriate.
- Replace cracked or damaged parts.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Setting the drinker too high or too low.
- Allowing water to become contaminated.
- Ignoring blocked nipples or leaking valves.
- Failing to clean drinkers routinely.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.

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